Staff answers & diagnostic guide — Deliberate practice and documented progression

Pathway: SUMMIT · Week 2 Part 1 · Big question: How do we use structured three-stage deliberate practice to master a target skill and document progression?

Starter answer & explanation

Question: Why do we change only ONE technical variable at a time between Study 1 and Study 2?

Correct: Changing one variable at a time proves exactly what caused the improvement in tone or edge quality — Exactly! Just like a studio experiment, isolating the variable teaches you repeatable control.

Guided team check (We do) answers

Q1: What is 'cross-contour' mark-making, and why does it make a form look more 3D than flat straight lines? -> Curving your shading strokes to follow the round surface of the object makes the viewer's eye feel its 3D volume (Yes! Cross-contour lines wrap around cylinders, spheres, and folds like wire rings.)

Q2: When working with diluted ink or watercolour wash, how do you soften a hard edge ('tide mark') before it dries? -> Rinse and blot your brush so it is just damp, then gently stroke along the wet edge to feather the transition (Spot on.

Feathering with a damp brush blends wet tone seamlessly into the paper.)

Q3: What must sit between Study 1, Study 2, and Study 3 on your portfolio sheet? -> Short diagnostic bridge notes naming the issue spotted and the specific adjustment applied in the next study (Correct. Those diagnostic bridges are what prove deliberate progression.)

Exit check answer

Question: How does cross-contour shading make a drawn object look three-dimensional?

Correct: The shading lines curve to follow the surface direction of the form, showing its roundness and volume — Correct. Cross-contour strokes map the 3D topography of the subject.